



ALMA MATER STUDIORUM
UNIVERSITÀ DI BOLOGNA

Lesson 5

ILAI (M1) @ LAAI I.C. @ LM AI

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Michael Lodi

Department of Computer Science and Engineering

These slides draw very heavily from Simone Martini's slides.

One-slide recap of lesson 4

`while`: unbound iteration. I need to take care of initializing and modifying the guard.

`list` is a compound/structured type (group of values each of its type). Mutable sequence.

Square brackets. Same operations of other immutable sequences, plus...

You can modify the value preserving the identity, Assignment with a selection on the LHS. No changes in the name-values binding, but change in the selection of the list on LHS. Powerful system but be careful with aliasing and side effects.

Never use `for` loop when the list length changes inside the iteration
(`for` freezes the identity, not the value).

Command `del` removes elements. Many methods on lists can modify the list (e.g. `append`). Often they return `None` (so do not use on RHS of assignment). Unlike operations, these methods do not create new objects.

Augmented assignment (e.g. `a += k`) is like a shorthand (e.g. `a = a + k`) but:

- 1) operation in place if possible (i.e. `extend` instead of `+` for lists);
- 2) LHS evaluated only once
- 3) LHS evaluated first (unlike any other assignment)

Functions can modify global mutable objects by accessing through parameters or through the scope (global scope is visible inside functions – more on this today...)

recursive function: call itself in her body. Need a base case and a recursive simpler (moving towards base case) case. Recursion is a form of repetition



Next lectures for ILAI

Monday, 29 September

15:00 – 18:00 (Regular, room 0.5)

Thursday 2 Oct: NO LECTURE

(prof. Lodi busy)

Monday 6 Oct: NO LECTURE

(cancelled in all ENG area, I believe, on 6-7-8)

Thursday, 9 October

11:00 - 13:30 (Regular, room 2.9)

ALL UPDATES ALREADY
ON THE COURSE WEBSITE

Use this time for trying exercises on Virtuale ;-)



Who to contact

For questions on exercises, on Python, tutoring/mentoring

1. contact **federico.ruggeri6@unibo.it**
2. if you still have questions (eg. Theoretical), contact me: michael.lodi@unibo.it

*For bureaucratic/administrative problems
related to this module 1 only*

1. **check very well the course/university websites**
2. contact me: michael.lodi@unibo.it

*For matters related to the whole course (ILAI) or integrated course:
contact Prof. Gabbrielli or Prof. Dal Lago*



A new problem: frequency count

Given the string

`s='When in the Course of human events'`

count the frequency of each letter

W appears 1 time

h appears 3 times

e appears 5 times

' ' appears 6 times

etc.

First try: use lists



A paradigmatic problem: frequency count

Much easier if...

we could directly use the elements of `s` (characters of a string) as index of objects (integer counts) in a suitable sequence/container



Dictionaries

A list is (mutable) mapping between
indexes and objects

indexes = initial segment of natural numbers

A dictionary is a generalization:

A (mutable) mapping between
immutable objects and objects



Dictionaries: mapping

Compound type

Mutable

A finite mapping between

immutable objects: the *keys* of the dictionary

arbitrary objects: the *values* of the dictionary

Generalize lists: mapping between $[0:\text{len}(S)]$ and objects



Dictionaries: dict

Values: Finite mappings between....

Presentation:

$\{\}$

the empty dict

$\{k1:ob1, k2:ob2, \dots, kn:obn\}$

the mapping sending k_i into ob_i

The pairs $k_i:ob_i$ are the *items* of the dictionary



Dictionaries: dict

`{k1:ob1, k2:ob2, ..., kn:obn}`

Example:

`{1:10, 2:20, 'one':20}`

Keys:

all distinct

all of immutable type (also any component, if any, should be immutable)



Dictionaries

Main operations:

len(D): numbers of items (pairs)

selection: D[k] k is a key (error if k not a key)

deleting: del D[k] k is key

mutable:

hence selection may be LHS of assignment

D[k] = object

set in D the pair k:object, *creating it if necessary*

k in D True sse *k is a key in D*



Dictionaries

Which of the following raise an error?

D1= {1:10, 2:20}

D2={1:10, 'a':3.14, 3:3}

D3={1:[1,2,3], 3:{1:10,2:20,3:30}, 2:(1,2,3)}

D3[5]='pippo'

D3[1][0]=100

D3[2][1]=20 *error (tuple is not mutable)*

D4={(1,2):[1,2]}

D5={ [1,2]:(1,2) } *error: key is mutable*

D6={ (1,[2]):23 } *error: key is mutable*



Dictionaries

No slices

No concatenation

they are not sequences

$D1 == D2$: True sse D1 and D2 have the same items,
independently from the order of the items

Listing the pairs of a dictionary respects the insertion order (only from Python 3.7)...

... but we will always consider dict as UNORDERED.



Dictionaries vs lists of pairs

$D = \{1:10, 'a':3.14, 3:30, 5:50\}$

$L = [(1,10), ('a',3.14), (3,30), (5,50)]$

Same information

Different efficiency of the access operation **by key**
list: sequential, hence $O(\text{len}(L))$ time
dict: hash access, constant time

***Access by key to a dict is as efficient
as an access by index to a list***



Dictionaries

for e in D:

*e varies on the **keys** of D
in which order?*

*From Python 3.7: in the order in which keys have been
inserted in D*

Before: in an arbitrary order depending on the machine



From L4:

Don't use `for` on lists in presence of
side effects!

Never (never !)
use `for` on lists,
*if their length
is modified in the `for` body*



Don't use `for` on **dict** in presence of
side effects!

Never (never !)
use `for` on **dictionaries**,
if their length
is modified in the `for` body



Don't use `for` on **dict** in presence of side effects!

This time it is an *absolute* prohibition:

*a modification to a dict which is used to control a for
raises a run time error!*



The method get()

Let's remember the frequency count
on a sequence S

This is wrong:

```
Freq={ }  
for e in S:  
    Freq[e] += 1
```

Raises a key error

The method get()

Let's remember the frequency count on a sequence S

```
Freq={ }  
for e in S:  
    if e in Freq:  
        Freq[e] += 1  
    else:  
        Freq[e] = 1
```

This is wrong:

```
Freq={ }  
for e in S:  
    Freq[e] += 1
```

Raises a key error

Common situation: check if key present, otherwise update

The method get()

```
Freq={}
for e in S:
    if e in Freq:
        Freq[e] += 1
    else:
        Freq[e] = 1
```

Using instead the method `get()`

`D.get(key, default)`

returns `D[key]` if it exists; otherwise returns `default`

```
for e in S:
    Freq[e] = Freq.get(e, 0) + 1
```

This is wrong:

```
Freq={}
for e in S:
    Freq[e] += 1
```

Raises a key error

Dictionaries: some methods

`D.keys()`

`D.values()`

`D.items()`

They return *view objects (dynamic lists)*

on keys, values, items (respectively)

(See the meaning of "view object" in Thonny)

On these views the operator "in" is defined

We may freeze these dynamic views:

`L=list(D.keys())`

`T=tuple(D.values())`



Method update(): a substitute for concatenation

Concatenation does not exist for dictionaries

The method update does something similar, when possible



Method update(): a substitute for concatenation

`D1.update(D2)`

extends D1 with the items of D2,
if there are equal keys in D1 and D2, the ones in D2
("update") are chosen

```
>>>
D1={"house":"casa","cat":"gatto","red":"rosso"}
>>> D2 = {"cat":"micio","grey":"grigio"}
>>> D1.update(D2)
>>> print(D1)
{'house': 'casa', 'cat': 'micio', 'red':
'rosso', 'grey': 'grigio'}
```



From dict to list

Use methods

```
D.keys()
```

```
D.values()
```

```
D.items()
```

and freeze them into lists. In particular

```
list(D.items())
```

returns as a list of tuples the items of the dictionary

```
list({1:'uno',2:'due',3:'tre'}.items())
```

returns

```
[(1, 'uno'), (2, 'due'), (3, 'tre')]
```



From dict to list

Warning:

```
list(D)
```

is equivalent to

```
list(D.keys())
```

From list to dict

`dict(...)` on a list of pairs returns a dict

```
dict([(1, 'uno'), (2, 'due'), (3, 'tre')])
```

returns

```
{1: 'uno', 2: 'due', 3: 'tre'}
```

**Accessing scopes:
globals(), locals(),etc.**



Global, enclosing, local scopes (or namespaces)

Scope: moment in the execution where some name is available

At any moment in the run of a program we have *four* scopes for names:

1. Built-In
2. Global
3. Enclosing
4. Local

Builtins are created when the interpreter starts up

Try

```
dir(__builtins__)
```

*Function `dir()` lists the *attributes* of the class of its argument



Global, enclosing, local scopes (or *namespaces*)

```
a=10
def f(s):
    x=20
    def g(u):
        return u
    return s+g(x)
w=f(a)
print(w)
```

Global, enclosing, local scopes (or *namespaces*)

```
a=10
def f(s):
    x=20
    def g(u):
        return u
    return s+g(x)
w=f(a)
print(w)
```

a and **w** are global:
defined at the top level



Global, enclosing, local scopes (or *namespaces*)

```
a=10
def f(s):
    x=20
    def g(u):
        return u
    return s+g(x)
w=f(a)
print(w)
```

`a` and `w` are global:
defined at the top level

`s` and `x` are local to `f`



Global, enclosing, local scopes (or namespaces)

```
a=10
def f(s):
    x=20
    def g(u):
        return u
    return s+g(x)
w=f(a)
print(w)
```

`a` and `w` are global:
defined at the top level

`s` and `x` are local to `f`

`u` is local to `g`

`s` and `x` are non local to `g` and non global
(or: in the enclosing scope)



LEGB

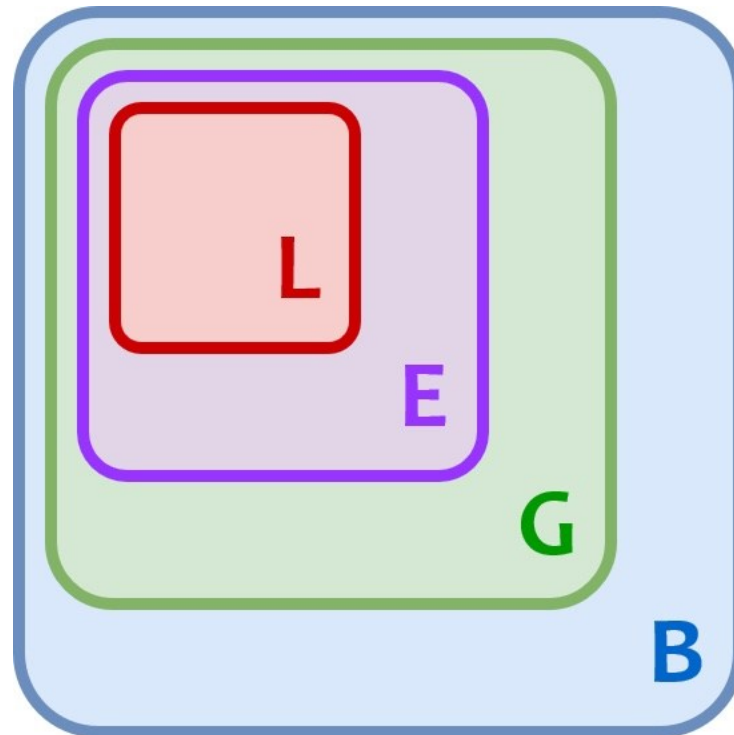
Searching for a name in the internal state works inside-out:

first Local

then Enclosing

then Global

finally Built-in



The global command

The global command

In a function definition

```
global <name>
```

signals that <name> should be taken from the global scope

```
A=10
```

```
def f():
```

```
    global A
```

```
    A=2000
```

```
f()
```

```
print(A)          #prints 2000
```



The nonlocal command

In a function definition

```
nonlocal <name>
```

signals that <name> should be taken from the nonlocal scope

```
A=10
```

```
def f():
```

```
    A=100
```

```
    def g():
```

```
        nonlocal A
```

```
        A=2000
```

```
    g()
```

```
    return A
```

```
print(f())    #prints 2000
```



The global and nonlocal commands

Use them sparingly!



Accessing scopes

`globals()`

returns the **dict** of the global names **with their**

binding

`locals()`

returns the **dict** of the local names **with their binding**

There is *not* a similar `nonlocals()` function

`globals()`

returns the actual dictionary
used by the abstract machine
➔ we may modify it

(not for locals...)



Have fun on Pythontutor

```
a = "global"
```

```
def f():
```

```
    a = "local to f"
```

```
    def g():
```

```
        a = "local to g"
```

```
        print(a)
```

```
        def h():
```

```
            #nonlocal a
```

```
            a = "local to h"
```

```
            print(a)
```

```
        h()
```

```
        print(a)
```

```
    g()
```

```
f()
```



Comprehension

In Set Theory

the comprehension principle
is the operation by which,
given a condition expressible by a formula $\phi(x)$,
we form the set of all those x meeting that condition:

$$\{x \mid \phi(x)\}$$



Comprehension: list

We usually form lists out of other sequences

E.g. The doubles of the numbers from 0 to 100

```
doubles=[]  
for i in range(0,101):  
    doubles.append(2*i)
```

It would be nice to have a compact way to express this
Something like: *the list of $2*i$ for i in the range(0,101)*

```
doubles=
```



Comprehension: list

We usually form lists out of other sequences

E.g. The doubles of the numbers from 0 to 100

```
doubles=[]  
for i in range(0,101):  
    doubles.append(2*i)
```

It would be nice to have a compact way to express this
Something like: *the list of $2*i$ for i in the range(0,101)*

*doubles=[$2*i$ for i in range(1,101)]*



Comprehension: list

Or also:

the even numbers out of a given list of integers LN

LN=.....

```
even=[]
```

```
for i in LN:
```

```
    if i%2==0:
```

```
        even.append(i)
```

Something like: *the list of those i in LN if $i\%2==0$*
even=...

Python allows this form of expression
which is called "comprehension" in set-theory, in math



Comprehension: list

Or also:

the even numbers out of a given list of integers LN

LN=.....

```
even=[]
```

```
for i in LN:
```

```
    if i%2==0:
```

```
        even.append(i)
```

Something like: *the list of those i in LN if $i\%2==0$*

even=[i for i in LN if $i\%2==0$]

Python allows this form of expression
which is called "comprehension" in set-theory, in math



Examples

1. The list of lists of numbers from 0 to i, for i less than 20

observe this is a nested comprehension

```
LL=[]
```

```
....
```

```
[[],[0],[0,1],[0,1,2],...,[0,1,2,...,19]]
```



Examples

1. The lists of numbers from 0 to i, for i less than 20

```
[ [k for k in range(i)] for i in  
range(20) ]
```

observe this is a nested comprehension

```
LL=[]
```

```
for i in range(20):
```

```
    AL=[]
```

```
    for k in range(i):
```

```
        AL.append(k)
```

```
    LL.append(AL)
```

Examples

1. The lists of numbers from 0 to i, for i less than 20

```
[ [k for k in range(i)] for i in  
range(20) ]
```

observe this is a nested comprehension

```
2. H = [ (x,y) for x in range(2)  
          for y in range(3) ]
```

```
3. from math import pi  
P = [round(pi,i) for i in range(6) ]
```



Equivalent form

```
T = [ (x,y) for x in range(2)
      for y in range(3)
      if x<y]
```

```
T=[]
for x in range(2):
    for y in range(3):
        if x<y:
            T.append( (x,y) )
```



list comprehension

The general definition is a bit obscure

A simple version:

```
[expression for name in sequence]
```

expression in a comprehension
is *always* evaluated

- after the *for name in sequence*
- in its local frame:

name is local to the comprehension

on Pythontutor...



list comprehension

A more complex version

```
[expression for name in sequence  
    series of for/if ]
```

equivalent to

```
res=[]  
for name in sequence :  
    series of for/if  
    res.append(expression)  
return res
```



list comprehension: exercises

1. Given a unary function f and a sequence S , return the list of the application of f to the elements of S
2. Given two sequences $S1$ and $S2$ return the list of the elements present in both $S1$ and $S2$ (don't bother about multiplicity: if e appears in both $S1$ and $S2$, maybe many times in $S1$, or in $S2$, or in both, it may appear with whatever multiplicity in the result)
3. Pythagorean triples: (a,b,c) such that $a^2+b^2=c^2$, for $a+b+c \leq k$



Challenge: permutations (via comprehension!)

```
def perm(L):
```

```
    "return the list of all the permutations of  
    the elements of L; does not modify L"
```

Example:

```
perm( [1,2,3])
```

returns

```
[[1, 2, 3], [1, 3, 2], [2, 1, 3], [2, 3, 1], [3, 1, 2], [3, 2, 1]]
```

Hint: argue recursively (so you can have a very simple base case)

The permutations of L are obtained by taking as first element, any element of L, and taking then all the permutations of....

You need an auxiliary function `erase(e,L)` which returns a copy of L from which e has been removed



Other comprehensions

On dicts:

```
{key:val for name in sequence}
```

Examples

```
{i:i**2 for i in range(10)}
```

```
{i:i**2 for i in range(10) if i%2==0}
```

```
{i:[k for k in range(i)]  
   for i in range(10)}
```



Sets: just a glimpse

Unordered collection with no duplicate elements

Useful to avoid duplicates

Fast operations like on dictionaries

```
e = set()    #do not use {}, which is empty dictionary
```

```
set("abracadabra")
```

```
>>> {'d', 'c', 'a', 'r', 'b' }
```

Unlike Python 3 dictionaries, still truly unordered

See docs for operations:

<https://docs.python.org/3/tutorial/datastructures.html#sets>



Set comprehension

You can have set comprehensions

```
{x for x in 'abracadabra' if x not in 'abc'}  
>>> {'r', 'd'}
```


Be careful: no comprehension on tuples

There is no comprehension on tuples



Be careful: no comprehension on tuples

There is no comprehension on tuples

Yet expressions which *seem*
"tuple comprehension"
are legal Python code...



Be careful: no comprehension on tuples

There is no comprehension on tuples

Yet expressions which *seem*
"tuple comprehension"
are legal Python code...

```
G=(i*2 for i in range(10))
```



Generators: super simplified view

```
G=(i*2 for i in range(3))
```

A generator is a kind of "*potential sequence/tuple*" which is able to *generate* the elements of the sequence, through the predefined function **next(...)**

`next(G)` : *evaluates to 0*

`next(G)` : *evaluates to 2*

`next(G)` : *evaluates to 4*

`next(G)` : *the generator is exhausted
an error is raised*



Generators: super simplified view

```
G=(i*2 for i in range(3))
```

Important use: a generator may be the <sequence> used in a for:

```
for e in G:  
    print(e)
```

for calls next(G) at any iteration (assign the result to e)

NB: a generator is a particular case of *iterator*, the general structure on which next() is defined and on which we may iterate with a for



Generators: explicit definition

List comprehension is a shorthand for an explicit iteration involving `append()`

Is there an explicit version of a generator?



Generators: explicit definition

```
G=(i for i in range(10))
```

```
def genstup(n):  
    for i in range(n):  
        yield i  
G=genstup(10)
```

```
Q=(i**2 for i in range(10) if i%2==0)  
def quadperf(n):  
    for i in range(n):  
        if i%2==0:  
            yield i**2  
Q=quadperf(10)
```



Generators

```
def fibonacci_generator():  
    a, b = 0, 1  
    while True:  
        yield a  
        a, b = b, a + b
```

```
fibonacci_numbers = fibonacci_generator()
```

```
for n in fibonacci_numbers: #infinite loop  
    print("Next fibonacci number is", n)
```



yield

The command

`yield expression`

could be used only inside the body of a function

The presence of `yield` make the `def` define a *generator*

`yield expression`

returns the value of *expression* and **suspends the evaluation of the function** (the frame is not destroyed, all the values of the local names are preserved, the point where execution is paused is preserved)



Recall: function

Two linguistic appearances:

Definition

```
def name (formal parameters) :  
    body
```

Use / call

```
name (actual parameters)
```

- evaluate the actual parameters
- bind these values to the formal parameters
- evaluate the body of <name> until a `return` is found
- evaluation happens in a local frame, which is destroyed at `return`



Generators: a very peculiar form of functions

Definition:

Any `def` whose body contains (at least) one `yield`

Use / call

- (1) A call to the name of the generator (together with its parameters) returns a generator object (the body is *not* evaluated yet!)
- (2) successive calls to the function `next(G)` on the the generator object, cause the execution of the body of the generator, until a `yield` is found
- (3) `yield expression` suspends the execution of the body, returns the value of `expression` as value of the call to `next(G)`;
the frame of the call is not destroyed and it is resumed at the next call to `next(G)`



Last year's exam question:

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Collatz_conjecture

```
def collatz_gen(n):
    while n >= 1:
        yield n
        if n == 1:
            return
        if n % 2 == 0:
            n = n//2
        else:
            n = 3*n + 1
```

Alternative, more elegant version version

with two yields and no return

```
def collatz_gen(n):
    # nb here we suppose n>=1.
    # If n<1 we should "return", otherwise it returns 1
    while n > 1:
        yield n
        if n % 2 == 0:
            n = n//2
        else:
            n = 3*n + 1
```

83 yield 1



Basic Patterns for Scanning Sequences or Collections

https://csed-unibo.github.io/#!pages/en/loop_patterns.md